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"If gender has been so thoroughly defamiliarized, why do we not have multiple gender options, multiple gender categories, and real-life nonmale and nonfemale options for embodiment and identification? In a way, gender's very flexibility and seeming fluidity is precisely what allows dimorphic gender to hold sway. Because so few people actually match any given community standards for male or female, in other words, gender can be imprecise and therefore multiply relayed through a solidly binary system. At the same time, because the definitional boundaries of male and female are so elastic, there are very few people in any given public space who are completely unreadable in terms of their gender" (20).

-> seems to be saying that gender expression standards are flexible. What counts for each gender is flexible, elastic. There are few who don't fit into it.

"Precisely because virtually nobody fits the definitions of male and female, the categories gain power and currency from their impossibility. In other words, the very flexibility and elasticity of the terms 'man' and 'woman' ensures their longevity. To test this proposition, look around any public space and notice how few people present formulaic versions of gender and yet how few are unreadable or totally ambiguous" (27).

"It is remarkably easy in this society not to look like a woman. It is relatively difficult, by comparison, not to look like a man... what makes femininity so approximate and masculinity so precise? Or to pose the question with a different spin, why is femininity easily impersonated or performed while masculinity seems resilient to imitation?" (28).

"What if a biological female who presents as butch, passes as male in some circumstances and reads as butch in others, and considers herself not to be a woman but maintains distance from the category 'man'? For such a subject, identity might be best described as a process with multiple sites for becoming and being. To understand such a process, we would need to do more than map psychic and physical journeys between male and female

within queer and straight space; we would need, in fact, to think in fractal terms and about gender geometries" (21).

-> connection to word embeddings and gender.

Gender system is enforced through bathroom system:

- the either/or nature of the bathrooms shows how we are thinking about gender, but the ability to pass in either shows how gender is malleable.
- men are less likely to be clocked, but risk greater violence if so.
- women are more likely to be clocked, but do not risk such violence.

Not about getting rid of male/female, but showing how they already do not work. To show "the breakdown of gender as a signifying system," that gender is already "excessively strange," to "hasten the proliferation of alternate gender regimes" (41).